

JSS 1 ISLAMIC RELIGIOUS STUDIES – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 6: RULES OF NUN SAKINAH AND TANWIN

1. Meaning of Nun Sakinah and Tanwin

Nun Sakinah (نْ) is the letter Noon that has a sukun (no vowel) on it. It is a permanent silent Noon that is written and pronounced.

Tanwin is an extra Noon sound added at the end of a noun. It is written as a double vowel mark: Fathatain (ً), Kasratain (ٍ), or Dammatain (ٌ). It is not written as a letter but is pronounced as a Noon with sukun.

2. The Four Rules of Nun Sakinah and Tanwin

When Nun Sakinah or Tanwin is followed by another letter, one of four rules applies, depending on the letter that comes next:

Rule 1: IZHAR (Clear Pronunciation) – ن ه ح ط ث ذ

Meaning: To pronounce the Noon clearly and distinctly without any nasal sound (ghunnah).

Letters of Izhar: The six throat letters – ن (Hamzah), ه (Haa), ح (Ayn), ط (Haa), ث (Ghayn), ذ (Khaa).

Examples:

- ن ه ا م ا ن ا (min aamana) – Nun + Hamzah
- ن ه ا د ا ن ا (min haadin) – Nun + Haa
- ن ه ا ب ن ا ز ع م ن ا (adhaabun azeemun) – Tanwin + Ayn

Rule 2: IDGHAM (Merging) – ن م و ي

Meaning: To merge the Noon Sakinah or Tanwin into the following letter so that they become one stressed letter.

Idgham is of two types:

a) Idgham with Ghunnah (nasal sound) – Letters: ن م و ي (Yaa, Noon, Meem, Waw)

Examples: ن م ي ا م ا ل (may-ya'mal), م ي و ا ل ي ي ن (miw-waliyyin)

b) Idgham without Ghunnah – Letters: ن ر (Laam, Raa)

Examples: ن ر ا ب ب ه م (mir-rabbihim), ر ه ا ف و ر ر ا ه م (ghafoorur-raheem)

Rule 3: IQLAB (Conversion) – ب

Meaning: To change the Noon Sakinah or Tanwin into a Meem (م) sound when followed by the letter ب (Baa), while applying a light ghunnah.

In the Mushaf, a small Meem is often written above the Noon to indicate Iqlab.

Examples:

- م م ا د ي (mim-ba'di)
- م م ع م ا ب ع ر (samee'um-baseer)

Rule 4: IKHFA (Concealment) – ن س ك ج د

Meaning: To hide the Noon sound partially – the tongue does not fully touch the place of Noon, and a nasal sound (ghunnah) of two counts is applied.

Letters of Ikhfa: The remaining 15 letters – ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■

Examples:

- ■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ (min-tahtihaa) – with ghunnah
- ■■■■■■■■■■■■ (an-zalnaa)
- ■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ (qawman-saaliheen)

3. Summary Table

Rule	Letters	How to Read
Izhar	■■■■■	Clear, no ghunnah
Idgham with Ghunnah	■■■■	Merge with nasal sound
Idgham without Ghunnah	■■	Merge without nasal sound
Iqlab	■	Change to Meem + ghunnah
Ikhfa	■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■ ■	Hide partially + ghunnah

End of Topic 6 – Rules of Nun Sakinah and Tanwin